

PEDIATRIC OCCUPATIONAL THERAPY EVALUATION

Evolving Therapy & Wellness

PART I: BACKGROUND INFORMATION & STRUCTURAL FRAMEWORK

1. Patient Identification

Field	Information
Patient Name	
Date of Birth / Age	
Medicaid ID #	
Address	
Primary Caregiver <i>(name, relationship, contact)</i>	
Caregiver(s) Present at Evaluation	

2. Reason for Referral

Area	Information
Referring Provider / Source	
Primary Reason for Referral	
Caregiver Chief Concern	

3. Birth History

Area	Information / Notes
Prenatal History <i>(complications, medications, exposures)</i>	
Delivery <i>(type: vaginal / C-section; gestational age; complications)</i>	
NICU <i>(Y/N; duration; reason)</i>	
Birth Weight / Apgar Scores	
Other Birth Notes	

4. Medical History

Area	Information / Notes
Diagnoses	
Medications <i>(name, dose, purpose)</i>	
Precautions / Contraindications <i>(weight-bearing, seizure, behavioral, medical)</i>	

Surgeries + Hospitalizations

Event	Date / Details / Outcome
Surgeries	
Hospitalizations	
Notes	

Medical Screenings + Recent Evaluations

Screening / Visit	Date / Provider / Findings / Concerns
Recent Physician / Pediatrician Visit	
Eye Exam / Vision Screening	
Hearing Screening	
Nutritional / Feeding Evaluation	
Developmental Pediatrician	
Neurological Evaluation	
Psychological / Behavioral Evaluation	
Other Screenings	

5. Occupational Profile

Area	Information / Notes
Social History <i>(what matters most to the family; stated therapy goals; caregiver burden; support system; daily routines)</i>	
Prior Level of Function <i>(baseline before current concerns emerged)</i>	
Current Level of Function <i>(present functional status across daily tasks)</i>	
Treatment History <i>(prior OT, PT, ST, ABA, other; frequency; duration; progress)</i>	
Assistive / Adaptive Devices Currently Used <i>(orthotics, AAC, mobility aids, adaptive equipment, sensory tools, etc.)</i>	
Sleep Habits & Positioning Concerns <i>(routine, duration, sensory factors, sleep positioning)</i>	

6. Home, School & Cultural Context

Area	Information / Notes
Primary Language(s) Spoken at Home	
Language(s) Used at School / Therapy	

Area	Information / Notes
Home Environment <i>(type of home, stairs, yard, relevant physical features)</i>	
Home Modifications in Place <i>(ramps, rails, adapted bathroom, sensory space, etc.)</i>	
School / Educational Setting <i>(public, private, ESE, inclusion, homebound, etc.)</i>	
School Modifications / Accommodations <i>(IEP, 504, aide, assistive tech, sensory accommodations, etc.)</i>	
Cultural Considerations <i>(values, practices, family dynamics relevant to treatment planning)</i>	
Other Contextual Factors	

7. Developmental History

List age of milestone achievement. Note: delayed / typical / advanced / not yet achieved / caregiver unsure

Milestone	Age Achieved / Notes
Head Control	
Rolling	
Sitting Independently	
Crawling	
Pulling to Stand	
Walking	
First Words	
Two-Word Phrases	
Toilet Training	
Self-Feeding	
Other Notable Milestones	

8. Standardized Assessments Administered

Assessment Tool	Date	Standard Score / %ile	Notes / Interpretation

8. Behavioral & Clinical Observations

Area	Observations
General Demeanor <i>(affect, engagement, comfort level)</i>	
Cooperation & Compliance	
Rapport with Evaluator	
Test Validity Statement <i>(results considered valid/invalid and why)</i>	
Other Clinical Observations	

PART II: PERFORMANCE SKILLS FINDINGS

SECTION 1: NEUROMOTOR & SENSORIMOTOR FOUNDATIONS

1A. Reflex Integration & Postural Reactions

Integrated = reflex no longer present as expected | Retained = persists beyond expected age | Emerging = in transition

Primitive Reflexes

Reflex	Integrated / Retained / Notes
Moro <i>(startle; integrates ~4–6 mo)</i>	
ATNR <i>(fencing posture; integrates ~6 mo)</i>	
STNR <i>(integrates ~9–11 mo)</i>	
TLR <i>(prone=flexion, supine=extension; integrates ~3.5 yr)</i>	
Spinal Galant <i>(integrates ~9 mo)</i>	
Palmar Grasp <i>(integrates ~5–6 mo)</i>	
Plantar Grasp <i>(integrates ~9–12 mo)</i>	
Babinski <i>(integrates ~12–24 mo)</i>	
Rooting <i>(integrates ~4 mo)</i>	
Sucking <i>(integrates ~3–4 mo)</i>	
Stepping <i>(integrates ~2 mo)</i>	
Notes	

Postural Reactions

Reaction	Present / Absent / Emerging — Observations
Landau <i>(prone suspension: head/legs extend; emerges ~3–4 mo)</i>	
Equilibrium — Prone	
Equilibrium — Sitting	

Reaction	Present / Absent / Emerging — Observations
Equilibrium — Standing	
Notes	

Protective Reactions (Parachute)

Direction	Present / Absent / Emerging — Observations
Forward (~6 mo)	
Lateral (~7 mo)	
Posterior (~9–10 mo)	
Notes	

1B. Neuromuscular Foundation

Area	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Muscle Tone (<i>hypo / hyper / fluctuating / WNL; note distribution</i>)	
Strength (<i>proximal vs. distal; note any asymmetry</i>)	
Endurance (<i>fatigue patterns; duration before decline</i>)	
ROM (<i>active vs. passive; note limitations and joints affected</i>)	
Posture & Positioning (<i>habitual postures; compensatory strategies</i>)	
Pain (<i>location, triggers, self-report or behavioral indicators</i>)	

Functional Ambulation & Mobility

Context / Area	Observations
Ambulation — Home (<i>independence level, surface types, falls, fatigue</i>)	
Ambulation — School (<i>hallways, gym, cafeteria, stairs, outdoor surfaces</i>)	
Ambulation — Community (<i>uneven terrain, distances, parking lots, stores</i>)	
Mobility Device Used (<i>gait trainer / walker / wheelchair / crutches / cane / none — note type and fit</i>)	
Transfers (<i>floor to stand; on/off chair, toilet, therapy table</i>)	
Stairs (<i>step pattern: reciprocal vs. marking time; rail use; independence level</i>)	
Notes	

Somatosensory / Tactile Discrimination

Note: Neurological tactile processing — distinct from sensory modulation in Section 3

Skill	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Stereognosis (<i>identifying objects by touch without vision</i>)	
Two-Point Discrimination	
Tactile Localization (<i>identifying where touch occurred</i>)	
Kinesthesia (<i>awareness of movement and joint position in space</i>)	

1C. Motor Planning (Praxis)

Type	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Postural Praxis (<i>imitating body positions</i>)	
Constructive Praxis (<i>building/arranging objects in space</i>)	
Sequencing Praxis (<i>executing steps in correct order</i>)	
Ideational Praxis (<i>knowing what to do with objects; concept of use</i>)	

SECTION 2: MOTOR COORDINATION

Gross Motor

Skill	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Locomotion	
Crawling (<i>pattern, symmetry, cross-lateral</i>)	
Walking (<i>gait, heel-toe, arm swing, cadence</i>)	
Running (<i>coordination, speed, deceleration control</i>)	
Jumping (<i>bilateral takeoff/landing, height, distance</i>)	
Hopping (<i>single leg; dominant vs. non-dominant</i>)	
Object Manipulation	
Throwing (<i>accuracy, force grading, arm pattern</i>)	
Catching (<i>bilateral, tracking, body positioning</i>)	
Kicking (<i>dominant vs. non-dominant; balance during</i>)	
Stability & Balance	

Skill	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Static Sitting (<i>unsupported; note duration, compensations</i>)	
Dynamic Sitting (<i>weight shifts, reaches outside base of support</i>)	
Static Standing (<i>feet together; note duration; eyes open/closed if applicable</i>)	
Dynamic Standing (<i>weight shifts, reaches, navigates obstacles</i>)	
Tandem Standing / Walking (<i>heel-to-toe; sway, arm compensation</i>)	
Single Leg Stance (<i>dominant vs. non-dominant; duration; note surface/footwear/vision conditions</i>)	

Note surface type, footwear, and visual conditions when documenting balance findings

Fine Motor

Skill	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Dominant / Preferred Hand (<i>R / L / mixed; consistency; age of establishment</i>)	
Grasp Patterns (<i>palmar, pincer, tripod, lateral pinch, cylindrical — note type used</i>)	
Release (<i>controlled vs. involuntary; grading</i>)	
Pinch Strength (<i>lateral, tip-to-tip, three-jaw chuck</i>)	
— Translation (IHM) (<i>moving object palm → fingertips or fingertips → palm</i>)	
— Shift (IHM) (<i>small linear finger-over-finger movements; e.g., adjusting pencil</i>)	
— Simple Rotation (IHM) (<i>rotating 90° or less; e.g., turning a peg</i>)	
— Complex Rotation (IHM) (<i>rotating 180°–360°; e.g., flipping pencil to eraser</i>)	
— Stabilization (IHM) (<i>holding one object in ulnar fingers while manipulating another</i>)	
Finger Isolation (<i>pointing, individual finger use</i>)	
Hand Endurance (<i>fatigue pattern during sustained fine motor tasks</i>)	
Fine Motor Activity Observations (<i>string beads, lacing, stacking 1-inch blocks — note accuracy, bilateral use, frustration tolerance</i>)	

Tool Use

Tool	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Scissors (<i>grasp type, open-close pattern, bilateral hand use; progression: snips → cuts</i>)	

Tool	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
<i>across page → cuts on line; note accuracy, endurance, hand cramping)</i>	
Spoon / Fork (<i>grasp, scooping, stabbing, spilling</i>)	
Knife (<i>if age-appropriate; spreading, cutting</i>)	
Keyboard / Typing (<i>if age-appropriate; finger isolation, bilateral use</i>)	
Notes	

Bilateral Coordination

Skill	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Symmetrical Bilateral (<i>both hands doing same movement simultaneously</i>)	
Asymmetrical Bilateral (<i>one hand leads, one assists; e.g., holding paper while writing</i>)	
Crossing Midline (<i>reaches across body without trunk rotation</i>)	
Notes	

Graphomotor Skills

Skill	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Pencil Grasp (<i>type; functional vs. dysfunctional; compensations</i>)	
Pencil Pressure (<i>too heavy / too light / variable / WNL</i>)	
Paper Management (<i>stabilizing with non-dominant hand</i>)	
Letter Formation (<i>directionality, starting points, reversals</i>)	
Letter / Word Spacing	
Sizing & Baseline Adherence	
Legibility (<i>overall readability at functional writing speed</i>)	
Writes Name (<i>independent / with model / emerging / not yet</i>)	
Copying Skills (<i>near-point vs. far-point; accuracy</i>)	
Writing Speed / Endurance	
Notes	

Pre-Writing Skills

Pre-Writing Form	Imitates and/or Copies: WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Horizontal Line (~2 yrs)	
Vertical Line (~2-2.5 yrs)	
Circular Scribble / Circle (~2.5-3 yrs)	
Cross (+) (~3.5-4 yrs)	
Diagonal Line (~3.5-4 yrs)	
X (~4-4.5 yrs)	
Square (~4.5 yrs)	
Triangle (~5-5.5 yrs)	
Draw a Stick Figure Person (~4-6 yrs)	
Notes	

Movement Patterns and Isolation

How the child physically produces written strokes — note patterns observed during writing tasks

Area	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Dynamic Finger Movements <i>(isolated finger movement to form letters vs. whole-hand pattern)</i>	
Wrist Stabilization <i>(wrist maintains stable position during finger movement; note resting wrist posture)</i>	
Whole Arm Movement / Compensatory Patterns <i>(writing driven by shoulder/elbow rather than fingers; arm dragging, hooking, trunk rotation)</i>	
Notes	

Foundational Stability (Proximal to Distal)

Proximal stability supports distal mobility. Core and shoulder stability directly affect hand control during writing.

Area	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Core Stability <i>(upright posture maintenance; trunk sway or collapse during seated tasks; leaning on desk)</i>	
Shoulder Stability <i>(arm locking or bracing; limited fluid arm movement; shoulder elevation during writing)</i>	
Functional Impact on Writing <i>(describe how proximal instability affects pencil control, endurance, and output quality)</i>	
Notes <i>(In-Hand Manipulation — see Fine Motor section above)</i>	

SECTION 3: SENSORY PROCESSING & REGULATION

Sensory Processing

Pattern: Seeks / Avoids / Mixed / Typical — note functional impact

System	Seeks / Avoids / Mixed / Typical — Observations
Tactile (light touch, textures, grooming, unexpected touch, clothing)	
Proprioceptive (body awareness, force grading, crashing/deep pressure seeking)	
Vestibular (movement tolerance, gravitational insecurity, spinning/swinging)	
Auditory (volume, unexpected sounds, background noise filtering)	
Visual (light sensitivity, visual clutter, busy environments)	
Oral / Gustatory (texture, temperature, taste; mouthing behaviors)	
Olfactory (avoidance or seeking of smells)	
Interoceptive (hunger, thirst, fatigue, pain, toileting awareness)	
Notes	

Vestibular Processing — Post Rotary Nystagmus (PRN)

Direction	Presence & Duration (sec)	Symmetry	Clinical Relevance
Toward Right			
Toward Left			

Clinical relevance: WNL / Absent / Prolonged / Asymmetric — note functional implications

PRN also cross-referenced in Section 5 — Ocular Motor

Arousal Level

Area	Observations
Arousal Level (low / high / fluctuating / WNL — note patterns across session)	

Self-Regulation

Area	Observations
Strategies Used (self-initiated vs. cued; effective strategies observed)	
Co-Regulation Needed (type and frequency of adult support required)	
Window of Tolerance (narrow / moderate / flexible)	

Behavior During Assessment

Area	Observations
Attention & Engagement <i>(sustained attention, distractibility, task transitions)</i>	
Frustration Tolerance	
Response to Demands <i>(compliance, refusal, shutdown, dysregulation)</i>	
Notable Behaviors <i>(stimming, aggression, elopement, repetitive behaviors)</i>	

SECTION 4: ORAL MOTOR & FEEDING

Oral Motor

Structure / Function	Observations
At Rest <i>(mouth posture, lip seal, tongue position)</i>	
Jaw Control <i>(stability, grading, jaw thrust)</i>	
Lip Movement <i>(rounding, retraction, seal during eating/drinking)</i>	
Tongue Movement <i>(lateralization, elevation, protrusion, retraction)</i>	
Cheek Function <i>(tone, movement, biting)</i>	

Feeding & Swallowing

Area	Observations
Sucking / Drinking <i>(straw, open cup, bottle — pattern and efficiency)</i>	
Biting / Chewing <i>(munching vs. rotary; grading; food breakdown)</i>	
Swallowing <i>(coughing, pocketing, wet voice, efficiency)</i>	
Texture Tolerance <i>(IDDSI level; accepted vs. refused textures)</i>	
Self-Feeding <i>(utensil use, independence level, adaptive equipment)</i>	
New Foods Accepted <i>(list foods accepted during session; caregiver report)</i>	

SECTION 5: VISUAL PERCEPTUAL & COGNITIVE

Ocular Motor Skills

Skill	Functional / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Fixation (<i>maintains steady gaze on target</i>)	
Horizontal Tracking (<i>smooth pursuit L → R across midline</i>)	
Vertical Tracking (<i>smooth pursuit up/down across midline</i>)	
Scanning (<i>systematic visual search of environment/page</i>)	
Convergence (<i>eyes moving inward for near tasks; note break point</i>)	
Divergence (<i>recovery from near to far; efficiency</i>)	
Notes	

PRN findings: See Section 3 — Vestibular Processing / PRN

Visual Perceptual Skills

Note standardized tool used (e.g., TVPS-4, Beery VMI, DTVP-3)

Skill	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Visual Discrimination (<i>differences in color, shape, size, orientation</i>)	
Figure-Ground (<i>finding form within busy background</i>)	
Visual Closure (<i>identifying incomplete or partially hidden images</i>)	
Form Constancy (<i>recognizing shapes/letters regardless of size or position</i>)	
Visual Memory (<i>short-term recall of visual sequences or forms</i>)	
Visual Sequential Memory (<i>recalling correct order of a visual series</i>)	
Spatial Relations (<i>position of objects relative to self and others</i>)	
Visual-Motor Integration (VMI) (<i>coordinating visual input with motor output; copying, tracing</i>)	
Visual Motor Task Observations (<i>simple insert puzzle, interlocking puzzle, connecting dots, object manipulation — note accuracy, speed, error correction</i>)	
Notes	

Body Scheme & Laterality

Skill	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Body Awareness / Scheme (<i>identifies body parts on self and others</i>)	

Skill	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Laterality <i>(awareness of own left/right)</i>	
Directionality <i>(projects laterality into space; follows directional commands)</i>	

Attention & Memory

Attention

Type	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Joint Attention <i>(shared focus; pointing, referencing, checking in)</i>	
Sustained Attention <i>(maintaining focus over time; note duration)</i>	
Selective Attention <i>(focusing on relevant stimuli; filtering distractors)</i>	
Divided Attention <i>(managing two tasks or stimuli simultaneously)</i>	
Alternating Attention <i>(shifting focus and returning without losing place)</i>	
Notes	

Memory

Type	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Short-Term Memory <i>(immediate recall without active manipulation)</i>	
Working Memory <i>(holding + manipulating info during active task; see also EF below)</i>	
Long-Term Memory <i>(retrieval of previously learned info or routines)</i>	
Procedural Memory <i>(motor/routine-based learning; automaticity)</i>	
Notes <i>(Visual Memory — see Visual Perceptual Skills above)</i>	

Cognitive & Perceptual — General Observations

Area	Observations
Overall Perceptual Pattern <i>(strengths and weaknesses across perceptual tasks)</i>	
Problem-Solving	
Concept Formation / Abstraction	
Notes	

Executive Functioning

Typically applicable 4+ years. Standardized tools: BRIEF-2, SKY-2

Area	WNL / Delayed / Emerging — Observations
Impulse Control (<i>acting before thinking; difficulty waiting</i>)	
Initiation (<i>starting tasks independently; prompt dependency</i>)	
Organization (<i>managing materials, workspace, multi-step tasks</i>)	
Planning (<i>anticipating steps; breaking tasks into parts</i>)	
Self-Monitoring (<i>awareness of errors; self-correction</i>)	
Emotional Control (<i>modulating emotional responses; recovery time</i>)	
Task Persistence (<i>sustaining effort through difficulty or non-preferred tasks</i>)	
Cognitive Flexibility (<i>tolerating change; shifting between tasks or ideas</i>)	
Working Memory (<i>see also Memory above</i>)	

SECTION 6: AREAS OF OCCUPATION

Independence: Independent / Modified Independent / Supervision / Min Assist / Mod Assist / Max Assist / Dependent

Self-Care (ADLs)

Area	Independence Level & Observations
Dressing (<i>fasteners, donning/doffing, sequencing, bilateral use</i>)	
Feeding / Mealtime (<i>utensil use, cup drinking, self-feeding, mealtime behavior</i>)	
Bathing (<i>participation, tactile tolerance, hair washing, sequencing</i>)	
Toileting (<i>transfers, clothing management, hygiene, awareness/initiation</i>)	
Grooming (<i>teeth brushing, hair care, face washing, routine tolerance</i>)	
Sleep Hygiene (<i>bedtime routine, sensory factors, sleep positioning</i>)	

IADLs (if age-appropriate — typically 12+ or by developmental level)

Area	Observations
Meal Preparation	
Home Management	
Community Mobility	
Safety Awareness	

Area	Observations
Notes	

Education & School Function (if applicable)

Area	Observations
Classroom Participation (<i>attention, transitions, following directions, group work</i>)	
Desk Skills (<i>posture, endurance, tool use, organization of materials</i>)	
Writing / Pre-Writing (<i>letter formation, spacing, pencil grasp, legibility</i>)	
Scissors / Fine Motor Tasks	
Functional Mobility in School (<i>hallways, stairs, gym, cafeteria</i>)	
Notes	

Play & Leisure

Area	Observations
Play Skills (<i>exploratory / functional / constructive / symbolic-pretend / rule-based</i>)	
Play Initiation (<i>independent vs. prompted; approaches peers vs. parallel</i>)	
Toy / Activity Preferences (<i>note sensory, motor, cognitive patterns in preferences</i>)	
Leisure Participation (<i>age-appropriate activities at home, community</i>)	
Notes	

Social Participation & Communication

Area	Observations
Joint Attention (<i>see also Section 5 — Attention</i>)	
Turn-Taking & Sharing	
Peer Interaction (<i>initiates, responds, sustains; note context</i>)	
Adult Interaction (<i>familiar vs. unfamiliar; compliance, eye contact, engagement</i>)	
Functional Communication (<i>verbal / AAC / gestural — primary modality</i>)	
AAC Device / System (<i>type, access method, vocabulary level, effectiveness</i>)	
Emotional Regulation in Social Contexts (<i>see also Section 3 — Self-Regulation</i>)	

Area	Observations
Notes	

PART III: SUMMARY & PLAN OF CARE

Plan of Care

Area	Details
POC Time Frame (e.g., 01/01/2025 – 06/30/2025 — typically 6-month range)	
Frequency & Duration (e.g., 1x/week x 60 min x 6 months)	
Service Delivery Model (individual / group / school-based / telehealth / home)	

Summary & Clinical Impressions

Area	Narrative
Strengths (strengths-based language — required for Medicaid)	
Areas of Concern	
Clinical Impressions	
Functional Impact Summary	

Long-Term Goals (LTGs)

#	Long-Term Goal
LT G 1	
LT G 2	
LT G 3	
LT G 4	

Short-Term Goals (STGs)

#	Short-Term Goal
ST G 1	
ST G 2	
ST G 3	

#	Short-Term Goal
ST G 4	
ST G 5	
ST G 6	

Recommendations

Area	Details
OT Services Recommended (Y / N)	
Rehab Potential <i>(excellent / good / fair / poor — based on motivation, support system, medical stability, and response to treatment)</i>	
Referrals to Other Disciplines <i>(PT, ST, ABA, psychology, medical, nutrition, etc.)</i>	
Home Program / HEP	
Caregiver Education Provided <i>(topics covered; handouts given)</i>	
Assistive Technology / Equipment	
Anticipated Discharge	
Other Recommendations	

Diagnostic & Billing Codes

Code Type	Code(s)
ICD-10 Diagnosis Codes	
CPT Evaluation Code	
Additional CPT Codes + Units	

Signatures & Credentials

THERAPIST

Therapist Signature: _____

Printed Name & Credentials: _____

Therapist NPI #: _____

License #: _____ State: _____

Date of Evaluation: _____ Date of Report: _____

REFERRING / AUTHORIZING PHYSICIAN

Physician Signature: _____

Printed Name & Credentials: _____

Physician NPI #: _____

Date: _____

Most Recent Doctor's Visit: _____